

Indian History – Detailed Notes

Prehistoric India

Paleolithic Age: Stone tools, hunting and gathering. Mesolithic Age: Microliths and domestication. Neolithic Age: Agriculture, pottery and settlements. Chalcolithic Age: Copper tools and village life.

Indus Valley Civilization (2500–1900 BCE)

Major cities: Harappa, Mohenjo-Daro, Dholavira, Lothal. Features: Urban planning, drainage system, seals, trade and agriculture. Decline theories include climate change and river shifts.

Vedic Period

Early Vedic and Later Vedic phases. Society, religion, political institutions and emergence of Mahajanapadas. Composition of Vedas and Upanishads.

Mahajanapadas and Rise of Magadha

16 Mahajanapadas, Bimbisara, Ajatashatru and expansion of Magadha.

Religious Movements

Jainism: Mahavira, Triratna. Buddhism: Gautama Buddha, Four Noble Truths and Eightfold Path.

Mauryan Empire

Chandragupta Maurya, Bindusara and Ashoka. Kalinga War, Dhamma policy and administration.

Post-Mauryan Period

Satavahanas, Kushanas and Sangam Age.

Gupta Empire

Golden Age of India. Achievements in science, literature and art. Aryabhata, Kalidasa and Nalanda University.

Early Medieval India

Harsha, Cholas, Pallavas and Rashtrakutas. Temple architecture and Bhakti movement.

Delhi Sultanate

Slave, Khilji, Tughlaq, Sayyid and Lodi dynasties. Administration and economy.

Mughal Empire

Babur, Humayun, Akbar, Jahangir, Shah Jahan and Aurangzeb. Mansabdari system and architecture.

Marathas and Regional States

Shivaji and rise of Maratha power. Sikhs and regional kingdoms.

Advent of Europeans

Portuguese, Dutch, French and British East India Company.

British Rule in India

Battle of Plassey, Battle of Buxar, Subsidiary Alliance, Doctrine of Lapse. Economic policies and social reforms.

Revolt of 1857

Causes, leaders, events and consequences.

Indian National Movement

INC formation, Moderates, Extremists, Swadeshi Movement. Gandhian Era: Non-Cooperation, Civil Disobedience, Quit India Movement. Subhas Chandra Bose and INA.

Constitution and Independence

Mountbatten Plan, Partition and Independence in 1947. Constituent Assembly and features of Indian Constitution.

Modern India after Independence

Integration of states, Five Year Plans, Green Revolution, economic reforms and contemporary India.

Important Dynasties and Dates

Dynasty	Period
Maurya	322–185 BCE
Gupta	320–550 CE
Delhi Sultanate	1206–1526
Mughal Empire	1526–1857
British Rule	1757–1947